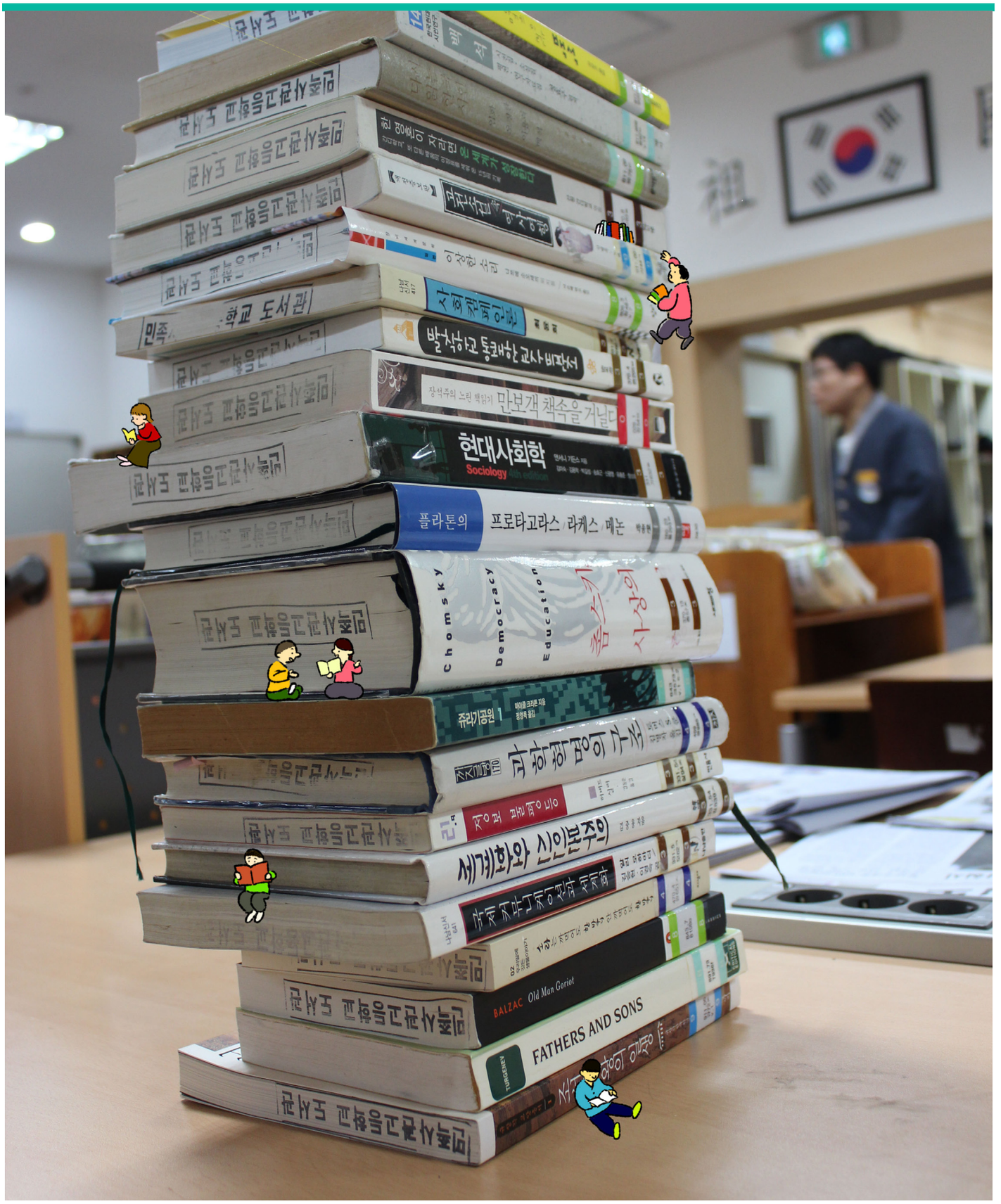
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EDITOR's NOTE

During my tenure as junior columnist in *Minjok Herald*, I once wrote an article on the pitiable state of the foreign books section in Mankyung Library. I have always wanted to dig a little bit deeper into this issue, one of book culture and reading in KMLA. A once-upon-a-time avid reader myself, I have always been regretful of the state of books here. As an extension to the article I wrote more than a year ago, I have asked these questions with staff: What do we read? What makes us read? What makes us not read? Why should we read?

These basic questions have led us to explore KMLA's reading culture in depth, through the eyes of students and teachers, outsiders and insiders, and classes and independent reading. Of course, these questions are but a start to a general plan–a plan that will hopefully make readers out of KMLA students. As you read through this issue, I hope you take the time to contemplate your own reading, what you have lost and what you have gained in KMLA in that respect. I hope you enjoy that contemplation, and I hope that contemplation is worthwhile.

Reading should be an important part of any academic life, for college and beyond. One of the pitfalls of Korean education is its disregard for reading; certainly, this pitfall is something that can be mended by KMLA and its students.

Minjok Herald, like press in real society, is a tool of problem identification. Hopefully, highlighting this problem to the best of our ability will bring forth necessary changes, whether in attitude or in policy. These changes, we believe, are vital to KMLA and to its future.

Park So-Hyeon
Editor-in-Chief
May 9th, 2014

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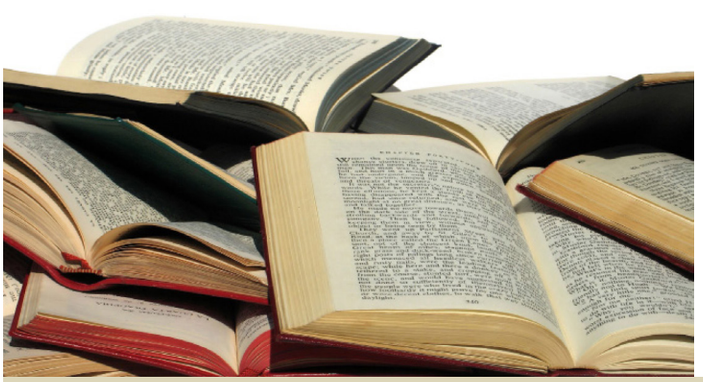
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voice of kmla verbatim



"But nowadays, I couldn't help but feel slightly worried…such proud founding values are losing their ground."

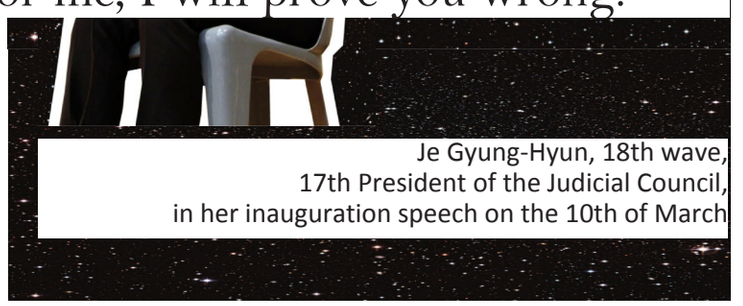
Lee Jee-Hoon, 18th wave,
in his speech during the first morning assembly of March

"All of us are in the gutter, but some of us are looking at the stars."

Sung Ho-Kyung, 17th wave,
16th President of the Legislative Council,
referencing a quote by Oscar Wilde in his retirement speech



"To those who did not vote for me, I will prove you wrong."



Je Gyung-Hyun, 18th wave,
17th President of the Judicial Council,
in her inauguration speech on the 10th of March

"The one and only goal of our department is always to prevent liberal democracy from turning into illiberal democracy."

Min Geon-Ho, 18th Wave,
in his inauguration speech
as the new Head of the Department of Audit and Inspection

"Our focus is quality maintenance of the status quo, namely, project study classes and student-teacher reading."

Mr. Na Jong-Uk
Deputy Headmaster for Academic Affairs

"Apparently, none of the 19th wave female students were tardy the entire week. I will nominate them for reward points for this laudable feat."

Mr. Kim Myung-Soon,
Director of the Division of Student Affairs,
referring to a semi-miracle in the first week of March

"Please, please read this—we spent the whole night writing it."

Lee Jae-Eun and Lim Han-Byeol, 18th wave,
reporters for the Bulhwigipeunnamo, KMLA's Korean newspaper,
in the sub-heading of their article on the candidates for the 17th Judicial Council

KMLA *in* NUMBERS



2 the number of consecutive wins for the EBS Scholarship Quiz, by 18th wavers Kwon Hyung-Gu and Koo Min-Seok

768 the number of Korean book arrivals in the Mankyung Library for the academic year 2013

246 the number of foreign book arrivals in the Mankyung Library for the academic year 2013

16 the number of months devoted to the renovation of KMLA Online (though in all fairness, Dotnet estimates a two-month dedication)

17 the number of people on crutches as of March 15th, 2014

24 the number of people who ran for the 17th Student Council

14 the number of people elected

39.33 the average number of posts in Meok9Sa9Pal9 (Inter-Student Facebook Market System) in a given day, sampled from 3/10~3/15

17th Wave Graduating Class Domestic 101 International 050
15th Wave Graduating Class Domestic 097 International 062
13th Wave Graduating Class Domestic 070 International 087

19TH WAVE

Total 157
Domestic 119
Humanities 53 Science 66
International 038

The Passing-Down-Goods Campaign Reveals Need for Textbook Contributions



At midnight between February 19th and 20th, KMLAians rushed into KMLA Online to receive goods that were either left behind by graduates or donated by enrolling students. The procedure was simple: visit the website and click the items on the list uploaded by the 16th Executive Council (No.425822). This campaign—passing down unnecessary goods to other students—was initiated by the 16th Executive Council, promoting the saving of resources by passing down unnecessary goods to other students.

November 20th of 2013 marked the official start of the campaign. Students donated their goods until December 18th through a Google document posted on KMLA Online (No. 421059). But not many students registered in the time provided, and the campaign was conducted mostly through collecting goods that 16th wave graduates left behind in the dormitory. The goods were arranged into six categories: books, workbooks for the International Field, workbooks for the Domestic Field, textbooks, school uniform, and household items. A total of 278 items were successfully passed on to 82 students. Seen from how fast the items were chosen, school uniforms and textbooks were most popular, but the two categories showed notable difference in quantity. Only 14 textbooks, compared to 54 uniforms, were passed down. In fact, textbooks were significantly small in number compared to any other category, as the second last in quantity, household items, consisted of 43 items. Considering that textbooks are the costliest and the most needful (For instance, The American Pageant, the United States History textbook, costs $129.80), more donations would have rendered the campaign more fruitful. However, most students continue to purchase textbooks through Facebook with money. A tradition of passing down textbooks would greatly lift the burden of incoming students, who are often surprised by the cost of numerous textbooks they must obtain for classes.

Other problems existed as well. Since most were gathered after graduates left instead of being donated, the original initiative was viewed by some as having been lost in the process. The campaign also involved some delay and students were restricted from using part of the dormitory lecture room in the 10th floor for a few days because goods had to be stored there. All in all, however, the campaign received good comments from the students. 17th waver Lee Yong-Kyun, who received two books in the campaign, commented, "It was great that I could get them for free. I hope the campaign continues as a KMLA tradition."

-

Lee Chang-Hun
Staff Writer, 17th Wave

Scholarship Quiz Brings KMLAians Outside the Box

Most KMLAians are used to testing their knowledge through tests, quizzes, and essays, marked by their teachers and shown in grades. Some, however, got a chance to do it differently. The EBS Scholarship Quiz provided a chance for ambitious students at Korean Minjok Leadership Academy to show off their knowledge in front a television audience, rigorously testing many abilities not usually needed in a normal school environment.

The program features several teams, each with two students trying to win a scholarship by solving questions that test a wide range of knowledge. Two seniors from KMLA took this quiz last year, and four juniors did so later in the semester. All did so in order to put themselves in a new environment and get experiences not offered in KMLA.

17th wavers Sung Ho-Kyung and Lee Jun-Hyup, previous participants of the EBS Scholarship Quiz, both emphasized the need for abilities not needed or used in the school they were used to. One example of this was quick thinking on the spot. Sung said, "I realized how valuable quick thinking was. Even the easiest questions felt difficult with the pressure of a television camera and the vivid ticking of a digital timer giving me only three seconds to hear, think about, and answer each question." Lee added, "How fast you think of the answer and press the buzzer determined the results."

Sung and Lee also stressed the need for knowledge outside books. Sung said, "School exams basically test your understanding of given material. The quiz, on the other hand, has no certain range, and sometimes contain basic material that complicated AP and university-level books overlook." The team's failure was a fresh shock reminding them of their lack of such knowledge.

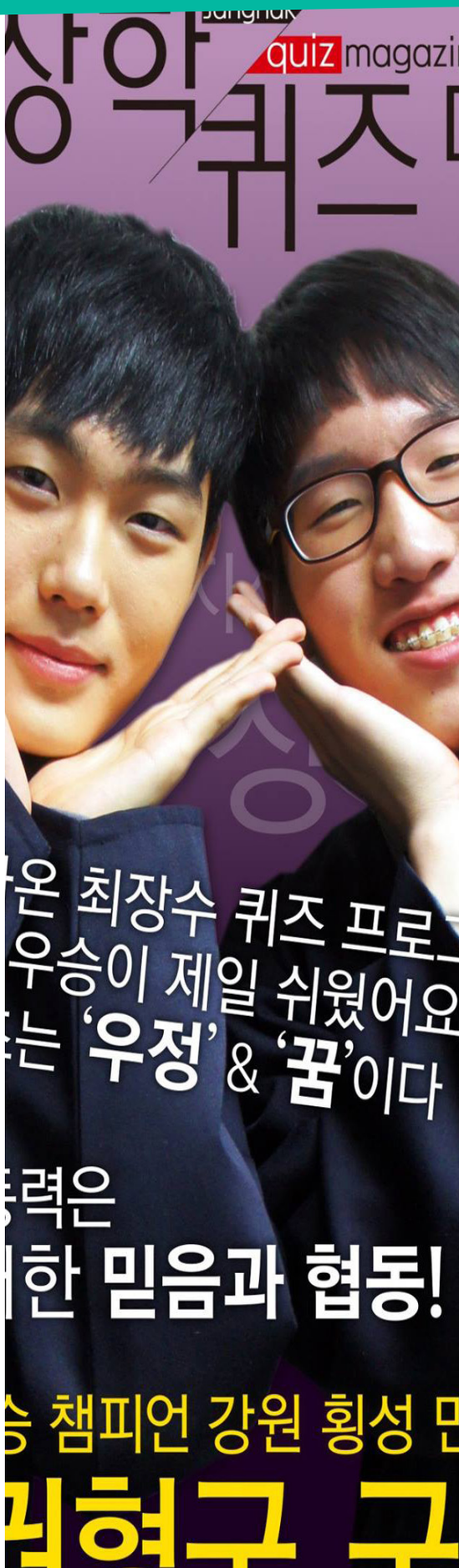
This fresh, stimulating experience motivated many other KMLAians to try out for participation. Four 18th wavers, Kwon Hyung-Gu, Koo Min-Seok and Han Jun-Yeob, Jeon Jae-Won, formed two teams respectively.

Han said, "I wanted to test how smart I was and to make my school proud." Kwon from the other team said, "I wanted to come out on air, especially in programs where I can test not only my knowledge but also my public skills in front of an audience. I believe participation in these quizzes has to be further encouraged by the school. Competition with people from other schools, in a fresh environment, is important for the development of KMLA students."

Kwon and Koo went to the EBS studio for the shooting on the 1st of March. They eventually went on to win the quiz program two times in a row, just missing three consecutive wins. Kwon said, "We did not expect anything. I guess luck just guided our way. We overcame our initial nervousness and mistakes, and that eventually led to us winning. We are so happy and proud. We hope other people follow our example and have a good experience for both themselves and the school." Their wonderful performance is to be aired on the 22nd of March and the 5th of April.

Despite their hectic life in KMLA, some students found the EBS Scholarship Quiz worthwhile enough to participate in. Although it may not be as rigorous or competitive as the school tests they often go through, this quiz provided a few ambitious KMLAians with a chance to withstand the pressure of public attention, think quickly, test their general knowledge, and get outside the box of their school life.

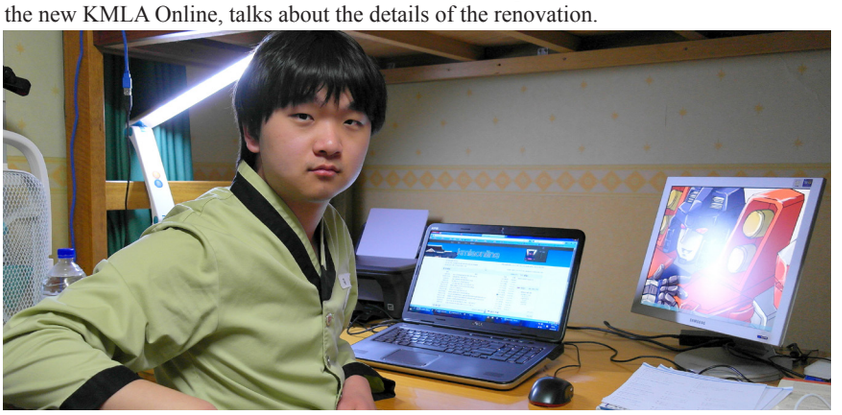
Cho Nam-Eek
Staff Writer, 18th Wave



Renovation of KMLA Online , Time for Rethinking the Budget Issue as Well?

For many KMLAians and especially for the newcomers of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, KMLA Online, the student website of KMLA, would be the first signal that tells and shows you that you are part of a circle, mostly referred to as the KMLA Family. 17th waver Gil San (shown in picture to the right), a well-known expert in computer science and programming, is one of those rare people that make this possible. He, along with other members of *Dotnet*, the club responsible for maintenance of KMLA Online, undertook a vast project taking 16 months from conception to finish: the renovation of KMLA Online.

Gil San, one of Dotnet's members and one of the principle architects of the new KMLA Online, talks about the details of the renovation.



Why the Change?

While the previous website has done its duty to serve the needs of KMLAians, there were some contentious voices that arose, complaining about the design and usability of the page. 18th waver Na Jun-Sung, commented, "From the beginning, KMLA Online had such defects that blocked me from doing the things I wanted. I remember putting up a bunch of posts just to upload several files." The sense of discontent, however, was not the only reason that prompted members of *Dotnet* to renovate the pre-existing site. 17th waver Je Dong-Il, Captain of *Dotnet*, said, "KMLA Online is now seven years old. Every year, members of the *Dotnet* Club have tried to improve the site. With problems such as insufficient data capacity, however, it never has been easy to manage KMLA Online. That's why we have decided to make a brand new site." Although the changes made inside the new KMLA Online seem simple, refurbishing KMLA Online was not an easy job. "Moving the data was the most arduous job of all. We had to make a whole new program just for the purpose of transporting the old data" said Je.

The Difficulties Behind the Scenes

But the problems concerning the new KMLA Online do not end with its discorded reactions in external design and function. The unmatched voices in the *Dotnet* club also prompted internal conflicts having different opinions about the funding of their new project. As the aftermath of these revamps were not taken care of properly, when asked about the financial support of maintaining KMLA Online, one of the *Dotnet* members, Gil San, expresses his sentiments: "Keeping KMLA Online up is not an easy job. We need support by rationing money from the Student Council funding, $20 per month(₩21500) in detail." Compared to the urgent cry of a *Dotnet* member, other members have shown different ideas about gathering the fund from the school. 17th waver Kim Sang-Woo, a web-designer in *Dotnet*, believes that there is no need for a funding externally and can be done autonomously. As users utilizing KMLA Online gratis, this proposal may not go unnoticed as the absence of funding may lead to the disappearance of a vital communication pathway among KMLAians.

The Renovation and Its Aftermath

The controversies surrounding the renovation do not go much further. Though some confusion still exists, the new KMLA Online certainly has many merits (see chart below for details). The questions raised by *Dotnet*, however, do need addressing by the student body. If we are to maintain our website, these issues must be resolved.

Kim Ho-Sung
Staff Writer, 18th Wave



Differences	The Old KMLA Online	The New KMLA Online
File Uploading	Only one file per post	Several can be uploaded using a ZIP File
Existence of a Tool Bar	Had to use Hypertext-Markup Language (HTML)	Tool bars where you can just press an icon
Replying on a comment	Not possible	Possible
Existence of a Gallery	Available but not easily accessible	Available and always shown on the main page
Customization	X	O

English Only Policy, Time to Call Quits to Debate?

English Only Policy (EOP) is one of the most widely debated issues in this school. Not even the teachers have an opinion of consensus; while some advocate for a hardline position on EOP, others would leave it up to the students to autonomously regulate and practice the policy. Here, we examine the key facts of this debate through the history of EOP. How did EOP come to place, since when did this policy become a source of hot dispute, and what can we do to resolve this issue?



EOP, Part of the School Motto?

Last semester, Mr Kim Myeong-Soon, the Director of the Division of Student Affairs, said, "EOP will never be gone unless this school is closed." Every morning, we recite the goal of EOP with the school motto. The motto is even inscribed onto elevator walls. According to a survey on Facebook conducted on April 30th, over 50% of all 18th and 19th wavers think EOP a part of the school motto.

EOP, however, is merely one of many policies implemented in the school throughout its history. According to the book "Changing Education, Changing the World", in 1997, the second year of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, EOP zones were first established in the second floor of the Chungmoo Hall. In that area, students were to use English for betterment of their speaking skills. The problems we face now began in 1999, when EOP was modified to become what it is right now: during a certain period of time every day, students were required to keep EOP everywhere on campus. The Director of the Administrative Office, Mr. Choi Gyeong-Jong, explains the reasons behind this expansion: "The reasons behind EOP is essentially why KMLA was established in the first place—that Korea is a 'weak country.' That EOP is being enforced upon students and that teachers are enforcing it upon students makes both sides uncomfortable. However, this discomfort, paradoxically, is the reason EOP must be kept. Because we hope that this discomfort will end as of your generation."

Mr. Choi remains absolute on this position. "If you do not want to keep EOP, I suggest you search for schooling somewhere else."

"As a private school, the administrators of KMLA have a responsibility to hold up the will of the founder", says Mr. Choi Kwan-Young, Deputy Headmaster for Educational Planning. "The founder believed the day EOP could be abolished is the day Korea becomes the leader of this world." It is a day that certainly has not come yet. At the same time, EOP is not part of the school motto, which means that it may be modified with the changes KMLA undergoes.

A Problem without Solution

Mr. Eom is a supporter of the idea that EOP should remain flexible. "A lack of flexibility is what always has been the problem. Since its opening, KMLA has changed much and many students have come and left. EOP, like other policies, should be modified and improved flexibly again and again. Especially for the 19th wavers, in which the Minjok Field students make up about 80% of the students, EOP should be altered so that it can be applied differently to the International and the Minjok Field students."

Not all teachers agree that this is true. Certainly, the Division of Student Affairs remains determined to keep EOP in check, even if that means the implementation of coercive measures. Students, too, are in disagreement about what should be done to resolve the situation. According to Mr. Choi Kwan-Young, "The Headmaster wanted the students to put in a voice into banning EOP violators from going home. This is why Student Council members collected student opinion on this issue." Divisive among students, the issue seems to divide teachers as well.

The Appeal to Patience

18 years have passed since KMLA was first established. EOP has been a part of this school for the last 17 years. 13 or 14 years ago, classes of first to fourth periods every day, from Monday to Sunday, were conducted in English. Teachers went around, identifying violators. With the passage of time, such an oppressive means of enforcing EOP was argued problematic; since then, EOP has been left pretty much at the hands of students. "Change comes slowly," says Mr. Choi Kwan-Young, "It took us 17 years to come this far. It will take much time for us to build a consensus on EOP and enforce it effectively."

Constant debate tires people out. Gradually, ennui is settling over KMLA on EOP. It has been debated too often with the same arguments and rebuttals. However, communication between different perspectives is the only way this problem can be solved. "It is the hope of the school that those who seek change not be exhausted by the slowness of the change," says Mr. Choi. As with so many different problems, communication seems to be key to this problem.

Lee Su-Yeon
Staff Writer, 18th Wave



Increase in Q & A Sessions Fails to Give Voice to Student Opinion

A major change was implemented to the 17th Student Council elections, marked by the elimination of speech sesions altogether. Previous election seasons had included both the campaign speech sessions and the question-and-answer sessions, each on separate days. Candidates pleaded their platforms and political views through speeches through the speech session; they were then evaluated through their answers to questions from the current Student Council, with some direct input from the voters. But in this election, campaign speeches were replaced with more question-and-answer sessions and debate through democratic mandate.

On the 24th of February, instead of full-length speech time, the candidates were each given a single minute to express and appeal themselves to the voters. The rest of the time was spent on individual questions. When that was over, candidates were grouped based on their answers on written assignments. The candidates debated within their groups on issues such as KMLA Plaza, student constitution, and Student Council participation in administrative conferences.

"The extended question-and-answer sesisons were meant to expand the opportunities for more debate and further questioning," says Yoon Min-Jung, the President of the 16th Judicial Council. The renovation failed in mainly two respects.

Firstly, many student questions went unanswered, as there was not enough time for follow-up questions anyway. 18th wavers Oh Yae-Lim, for instance, had asked about the "Did Not Follow Teacher's Directions" rule, asking what the 17th Judicial Council would do to clarify its arbitrariness. Her questions were largely answered through vague phrases, such as "We will work with the school to formulate clearer agendas." Oh later expressed that this wishy-washy answer was not what she had been asking for. Unfortunately, there was no more time left; she never received a direct answer to her questions. Kim Jang-Won, another 18th waver, expressed the same sentiments. His question: "What is the purpose of holding student court?" The question was "met with a strange jumble of rhetoric, but I never had the chance to get to the bottom of it all", he says.

Secondly, the question-and-answer session largely failed to bring light to the inadequacies of the written assignments. Having concentrated heavily upon debates between the candidates, 17th waver Hwang Hye-Jung expressed her regret at the missing questions. "For the Executive Council, the school calendar is of the utmost importance. But as the question-and-answer session did not deal with these administrative issues, only focusing on issues of principle, I found that students were less informed of the equally important issues in the election."

Of course, the question-and-answer sessions conducted by student press did function as a supplement to these unanswered questions. But a sudden elimination of speech sessions seem to have caused a great deal of confusion, having failed to address the problem of unanswered questions and also resulting in the neglect of the more practical issues. Whether such mistakes in-process impacted the results of the election is a question that only time can answer.

Lee Chang-Hun
Staff Writer, 17th Wave

Muddy Roads Call for Future Attention: Cross-Country Trip and Its Ups and Downs

February is the month of a new start for the family of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy. With the coming of 2014, 16th wavers have left the school and new faces of the 19th wave freshmen have entered it. To help the freshmen adapt to KMLA life before the Entrance Ceremony, Korean Minjok Leadership Academy annually holds the freshmen orientation during February. During this time, KMLA offers several unique programs such as the MBTI test, handing out Know How Do How, and meetings with upperclassmen. This year, a cross-country trip was added to the schedule. Throughout the interview with Representative aAdvisor of 10th grade Mr. Sung Heon-Je and 19th wavers, Minjok Herald looks into the reason for the new program and gathered opinions and valuable experiences of freshmen after the trip. The cross-country trip, in which freshmen walked about 13 km around Hoengseong views the beautiful landscape of the surroundings of KMLA on February 20th. Not only the 157 freshmen but also all of 10th grade advisors participated in the event.

There was certainly much concern about this new event, before and after it took place. Many pointed out the overwhelming vigor of the program. "Though it was fun, I thought we nearly died while 'climbing' up the steep and muddy path. Thus, during lunch time, most of students nearly shoveled the food into their mouth, and lay on the floor to sleep and rest," said 19th waver Gang Eun-Bin. 19th waver Park Min-Jae said that the way to the highway near Saemal was the hardest course since the road was too muddy. On the other hand, 19th waver Kim Dong-Ok expressed things in a more positive light. "As I walked through muddy roads, mountain paths, and even a brook, I forgot all worries about my upcoming life in KMLA. Moreover, we sometimes pioneered our own path, rather than choosing to merely follow the paths well-trodden; we held our hands together to cross the wobbling stone bridge. But, after the trip it was hard to even walk up the stairs to the cafeteria." She said that students did not fall behind, instead doing their best and encouraging others to finish the course.

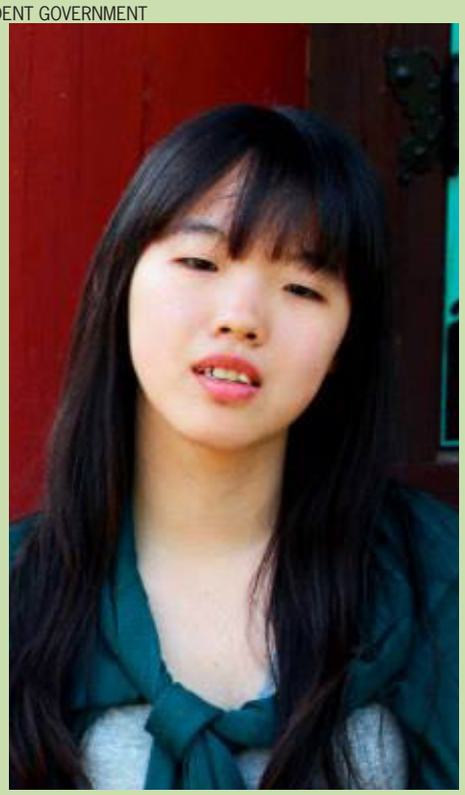
The teachers seem to be proud of the freshmen. According to Mr. Sung, the original plan was to take a two-day trip to Taekwondowon, but it was inevitably discarded due to several problems such as time constraint. "By participating in this trip, KMLA expects freshmen to learn various lessons; for example, to improve their perseverance and self-restraint, to honor the bravery and the patriotism of the soldiers who fought in the Korean War as they visit the war memorial, to reinforce their obligation to work to benefit Korea in the future in mind, and to think of their nation and their fellow countrymen throughout the trip." He commented that freshmen diligently followed teachers though some of them reached physical limits, and showed respectful attitude in the commemoration park. However, Mr. Sung hoped to have more realistic and less tightened schedule next year.

Since the cross-country trip was introduced this year, there will be some room for improvement regarding its rigor, and Mr. Sung stated that he hoped that a more realistic and detailed schedule for the trip will be implemented next year. Yet another tradition is seeking to establish itself in KMLA.

Kim Ri-Hyun
Staff Writer, 17th Wave









What the 16th Student Council Left Behind And What the 17th Student Council Promised

(From left to right: 16th Student Council Presidents, Sung Ho-Kyung from Legislative, Yoon Min-Jung from Judicial, and Cho Seung-Hyun from Executive).

The first semester of 2014 is in full bloom, and many old faces have been replaced by new. The 16th wavers have graduated and fresh-faced 19th wavers are wandering around the school, beloved mentors have changed places with eager new teachers, and the 16th Student Council has passed their positions onto the 17th Student Council. Looking back, the second semester of 2013 was a busy period, even more so because of its briefness. Throughout those hectic times, the 16th Student Council was hard at work, bringing to life the manifestos they presented to us at the beginning of their term. Though some have passed unnoticed, some of the clauses have brought unmistakable changes to student life in KMLA. As the new Council begins its work, the evaluation of the previous Student Council for what they have and have not accomplished seems necessary.

Legislative Council: Ideas Opened but Never Closed

The three key themes of the Legislative Council, as expressed in their manifesto, are communication, efficiency, and independence. Ultimately, they aimed to increase participation in school affairs.

The goal of communication consolidated into a KMLA Hearing—KMLA Talk on a small scale within narrower topical boundaries—which was vetoed by the school with the rationale of lack of solvency. The Legislative Council opted for a KMLA Plaza instead, an online forum enabling active communication between teachers and students. Opposing voices did exist: 18th waver Je Gyung-Hyun said at the time of its passing that "The original purpose of the KMLA Hearing was to solve the communication problems between teachers and students by providing an opportunity for direct face-to-face conversations. The focus of the KMLA Plaza seems to be on the efficiency of communication, which is a bit off track." The bill did pass with a majority, but the school chose to strike it down. "We cannot allow for unregulated communication between teachers and students," said the school's written response. KMLA Plaza made its appearance again within the written assignments of the 17th Student Council elections.

The most noticeable change with respect to efficiency was the computerization of votes. This technical change certainly has increased the convenience in calculating statistics, but many warn about the climbing apathy in the actual meetings. 18th waver Chang Min-Woo, class president, said "Undoubtedly, it was more difficult to get people to participate in the actual debates, as they no longer had to vote during the class conference." Whether this computerization has bettered student participation has yet to be seen.

Independence is the least clear theme. The Legislative Council had been promoting a student constitution—a bill of rights of sorts, delineating student rights

that must be held superior to Student Regulations. Proposed in the 14th wave, it was meant to provide a safeguard of rights, as the Student Regulations only limits them. According to a draft of the constitution, for instance, "Students will not be punished for the transgressions of others" effectively combats curfew complicity. This proposal was rejected by the school on grounds that "no rules may be held superior to the existing regulations, especially if these rules have been composed by the student body."

The 17th Legislative Council is expected to carry on these policies. It is too early to tell how different candidates, brought together under one council, will put together a single plan for action. Kim Seong-Hyun, the newly elected President of the Legislative Council, says he will start by legislating Student Rules, an autonomous set of regulations directed and enforced by the student body, as opposed to Student Regulations, upheld by the school. The 16th Legislative Council had passed one regarding cafeteria rotations; we have yet to see the problem identifications of those incoming.

Executive Council: Some Questions, Some Answers

The Executive Council characterized itself by care and convenience. To its credit, the Executive Council seems to have extensively thought through student convenience within the school. The most significant changes regarding this are the offline calendars posted on the cafeteria bulletin board and the ingenious manitto delivery service they've implemented from the start of the semester. Such servitude was unbecoming of student leaders, according to some. 18th waver Ha Su-Min said, "I'm not sure why the Executive Council would want to waste their energy by concerning itself with other people's errands. They're here for the whole student body and to work for the school, not to tire themselves out by being the postman." In the student evaluations, however, 67% of the students rated this policy as positive.

The Chungmoogong Project, an attempt to initiate grassroots contemplations and actions on problems identified in the school—like EOP, class quality, and educational philosophy—was abandoned as well, having made its brief appearance in the Manifesto. The project was basically about bettering the school, meant to be a long-term investment; sadly, it was never resuscitated. Shim So-Ho, a 16th waver, uploaded a post on KMLA Online wondering where the Chungmoogong project has disintegrated to. No coherent response was available.

Improvement of the department structure of our government—a problem which has raised its head repeatedly through the years—was a major part of the Executive Manifesto; unfortunately, none of the Executive Council's policies, if implemented at all, seems to have had effect. A major issue raised during the 17th Student Council elections was, yet again, the department structure and work allocation.

The President of the Executive Council, Koo Ja-Seung, seems to be determined to bid farewell to this problem once and for all. As most departments have already gone through their selection process, he plans to "implement the inter-department trading system" and "reallocate duties for certain departments"—more specifically, the Department of Audit and Inspection, the Department of Public Information, and the Department of Education. We have yet to see a major change taking place.

Judicial Council: Simple Promises, Simple Fulfillments

Among the three councils, the Judicial Council is showing the highest rate of accordance between their manifesto and their action. Since the beginning, the Judicial Council called for basically two things: fairness and efficiency. The first they sought to achieve by reciting their verdict of final defending speeches during court sessions and posting the results online. The student evaluation of this activity was positive—over 50% of the students rated this as enhancing communication between student government and the students. The second they achieved by constantly endeavoring to talk about the curfew regulation with the dormitory teacher. The issue was discussed during class conferences twice, and the students finally had it their way. Curfew complicity was formally abolished.

Whether its policies have helped promote fairness and efficiency remains in question. The posts in KMLA Forum, designed to foster discussion over the decisions of the student court, have been met with only lukewarm responses. Only two out of all court sessions conducted has received online comments; the results of these online deliberations were never publicized.

The candidate assignments for the 17th Judicial Council did not give room for campaign promises; in fact, the 16th Judicial Council had explicitly discouraged presentations of new policy. Ironically, the President of the 17th Judicial Council, Je Gyung-Hyun, had brought up the idea of jury pool. As of now, juries are selected at random, causing problems of apathy. To solve this problem, Je had said, we should limit the pool of jurors to volunteers, people who are actually interested in the proceedings. This policy raised much controversy during the elections, from the method of selection to possibility of prejudice. At the start of her term, Je has stated her will to reconsider her idea.

The election of a new student council always raises concerns about policy sustainability. Certainly, voters hoped to see more consistency in the shift from the 16th to the 17th Student Council. In his retirement speech, the 16th President of the Executive Council, Cho Seung-Hyun, said "You can forget what we did, or how we did it. But never should you forget why we did what we did." The 17th Student Council will do well to remember these words.

Lee Sun-Ha and Roh Hye-Sung
Staff Writers, 18th Wave

Bottled Water Prohibition: Loudly Protested, Largely Ignored



During the Monday morning assembly on March 10th, 2014, Mr. Kim Myeong-Soon, the Director of the Division of Student Affairs, announced the prohibition of bottled water. This prohibition includes both ordering water from the outside and bringing personally purchased bottled water. The former means any bottled water brought through post would immediately be sent back; the latter is only "encouraged." As of May 13th, that announcement is two months old. And yet it is still quite easy to spot KMLAians with bottled water. In fact, according to an online survey conducted from May 10th to May 13th, over 60% of the 41 students responded that they had at one point brought bottled water to the dormitory after the prohibition. So what is happening?

The school identifies mainly two problems with bottled water, as seen by records of the conversation that took place between the Headmaster and the Student Council on March 11th. One is that it is excessively difficult for the mailman to transport so much bottled water to the school, as the packages are quite heavy. The second is based on the school's belief that students should trust the school's water. The first reason does not legitimize an outright ban; the school's rationale, therefore, lies chiefly on the second.

The school has done everything to allay fears of a tainted water supply, in response to student complaints that the water is unpalatable, according to the President of the Legislative Branch, Kim Seong-Hyun. New fountains have been installed, not only in the Dasan Hall and Chungmoo Hall, but also in every floor of the dormitory; the quality of the water was checked and the result of the examination posted for students in KMLA Online. Mr. Lee Joo-Moon, the Head Teacher of the Department of Natural Science, went so far as to deliver a reassuring lecture on the subject on the 24th of March, arguing that KMLA's water supply is every bit as good as that of Evian, the overpriced French bottled water brand.

Despite all this expenditure (notwithstanding the extensive explanation of the rationale behind the decision), the same survey shows that 92.5% of the students disagreed with the school's decision, showing lack of support for the problem identification of the school. "The students are not questioning the quality of the water," says 17th waver Yoon Min-Jung, former President of the Judicial Council. "The right question to answer is, 'Why can't we choose the water we want to drink?' We have been excluded from the decision-making process on solving a problem that directly affects our daily lives. Students should not be expected to comply with regulations borne of questionable justifications." "Should the school mandate what kind of pens we should use, for the sake of minimizing waste? I think I have a right to be respected when I say I do not like the water the school provides. It is food, and it is a matter of personal preference." says Park Jae-Wan, an 18th waver. Yet Kim, the President of the Legislative Council, says that "The window for communication has been shut. The school remains firm in its stance that 'the water supply is clean,' and says nothing more, nothing less."

Without proper response from the school, student complaints are turning into outright violations of this prohibition, as students continue to bring in water through their parents. The decision is going to need additional enforcement if it is going to be the new norm. Effective regulation will take inspection of private quarters and possibly demerit points, though the school has not said anything in kind so far. "The 20th wave will come in, not knowing what used to be. The school will have it its way at the end. So it goes." says Kim.

Kim Ye-Seul
Staff Writer, 18th Wave

INTERVIEW WITH MS. SEUK



A new school year has commenced since February. A new year, new mind, and several new faces are seen around the campus. In the English department we have Ms. J. E. Seuk with us from this semester, whom the *Minjok Herald* interviewed today.

Minjok Herald: Can you briefly describe about your life or occupation before KMLA?

Ms. J. E. Seuk: I've been teaching for over a dozen years now—three in Gangneung, a couple years before that in the Seorak Mountain, and before that I was teaching in New York, where I'm from, and Chicago. Most of my adult life, teaching in one form or another in one place or the other has been how I put food on the table, but it's also what I love. I've been extraordinarily lucky in that my entire adult life in a sense that I've never had a terrible boss. Most of my friends had places where they just hated work. There are pros and cons to every place, but I've been lucky that there were more pros than cons everywhere that I've been.

MH: What are your daily interests?

Ms. Seuk: Music mostly; I play the mandolin. I've always been a nerdy bookworm ever since I was a kid so I'd like to tell students to read for pleasure above all. Whenever you can just stick a fun book in your bag, put away the smartphone and just read. I also like walking around, trying to explore a little bit. I like to write too, but just for myself. I probably watch too much American TV, but I say it's too keep up with pop culture and a couple issues of the day. I used to be interested in TV writing, but ultimately, I really love teaching.

MH: How did you gain interest in literature?

Ms. Seuk: When I was really young, my parents—strictly Koreans—immigrated into the States. They're both really intelligent people, but as soon as they went to the States, they were mocked at by the supermarket kid bagging groceries. They were ignored because of their lack of English language skills and their accent when they could say something correctly. They didn't want that for me or for my sister and they really wanted us to master English. We started from watching Reading Rainbow, Sesame Street for hours and hours. Every Saturday, my sister and I would go with my dad to the public library and we loved it. I was constantly reading. As soon as we learned English, they took away the TV! I am grateful for my parents for the decision because I love reading books. Ever since I was a kid I just knew that I would be an English major.

MH: How did you find out about Korean Minjok Leadership Academy?

Ms. Seuk: I was living in Gangneung before Wonju—where I moved just because of this job—and one of my friends there used to participate in the KMLA camps. She would talk about it and say how unusual it was for a high school in Korea. This sounded very intriguing and the name stuck in my head. Then I saw random job postings on the internet. I did love my old job, but I was also interested in something new, something a little bit different, and when I saw the one by KMLA I'd thought that the school name sounded vaguely familiar.

MH: What attracted you to KMLA?

Ms. Seuk: First of all, I haven't worn a hanbok ever since my first birthday, so the fact that everyone wears hanboks everyday just standed out. Also, while I was looking for different jobs in different places, the one in KMLA sounded exceptional to me. However it didn't strike me as attractive until the day I came for my interview. I had to conduct a demo class with several seniors at that time, and they struck me as outstanding. I remember coming in thinking, "This is supposed to be one of the top private high schools in Korea, and they do get crazy scores—higher than average from top American private high schools where I used to teach—I'm going to talk to them as if I'm speaking to an American English Honors class". So I got in there, and started with pretty fast talking at a really high level of diction, but impressively they all kept up with me. I wanted to teach kids like that who have that intrinsic curiosity and excitement about learning something new.

MH: It's been a month since you came here. How do you find overall life at KMLA?

Ms. Seuk: I am still slightly bewildered. I feel that every day there is something new to learn regarding forms or new students. But I do like it. I do miss New York, but honestly right now, I'm enjoying my life in Korea too much to want to go back.

MH: Then are there any difficulties in KMLA?

Ms. Seuk: Honestly so far regarding anything I run across that poses any problems, my fellow teachers here have been incredible. They're so nice and they're always helping me out. Nothing really bad so far!

MH: Is there anything else you want to gain?

Ms. Seuk: A little bit of stability would be nice. I can't really ask for much more. I'm happy! Not a lot of people can be happy with their personal lives and their jobs at the same time but I am getting the whole pie.

MH: Finally, do you have any last word for the KMLAians?

Ms. Seuk: This is a really special place, and everyone here are special. Never take it for granted. Learning for the sake of learning and to be able to do that in this environment, is something that's really special. When you become an adult, your world becomes bigger but narrower doing the same things all the time; when you're younger you get to have so many different interests and different clubs and I miss that. Some of it sucked, but there was a lot of excitement in being able to do different things and have some choices how I spend my time with interests, so never take it for granted.

Roh Hye-Sung and Kang Woo-Sang
Staff Writers, 18th Wave



INTERVIEW WITH MR. LEE

Barely after the curtains closed for 2013 and revealed 2014, Mr. Yoon Jae-Sung, a former physics teacher at Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, transferred to a different school. KMLA sought for a new physics teacher, and found one: Mr. Lee Seung-Ho. Having majored in theoretical physics abroad, Mr. Lee brought with him a wave of interest from the students.

Minjok Herald: Hello, Mr. Lee, and welcome to our school. Could you tell us a brief story about your life?
Mr. Lee Seung-Ho: Well, I grew up in Jeonju until 5th grade and discovered my interest in physics during middle school. And as you already know, I majored in theoretical physics—particle physics, to be more specific. I guess that's all you really have to know.

MH: What influenced you to major in physics?
Mr. Lee: That is a big question. My interest for physics grew steadily as I graduated middle school and high school. After getting into college was when I really started to study physics. I gained interest in physics mostly through reading books. Schoolwork did get me involved in some physics, but not as much as reading. After all, we used to have more than 50 students in one class, which did not allow teachers and students to talk freely about their academic interests. KMLA students are very privileged in that sense. During college, sharing thoughts with my peers was a huge help for me in studying physics—something that I was not able to do during high school. But students here are able to share their thoughts freely with each other and the teachers. Sorry for digressing. This was something that I always wanted to tell the students.

MH: Then how did you become a teacher of KMLA?
Mr. Lee: Just as I would get any other job: I did not know much about KMLA before, but heard that KMLA was looking for a physics teacher, so I applied and had an interview. Soon after, they told me that I would suit the job. Not much drama there.

MH: How are you enjoying life in KMLA?
MR. Lee: Quite decently. I'm staying at the Residence Hall. Nothing much special to talk about, I guess.

MH: I see. How is teaching in KMLA like?
Mr. Lee: Again, things are quite decent here. Every teacher has his or her own office, and every student chooses his own classes. How cool is that? I don't doubt that the students here are some of the best—especially in English—and they seem to be catching up nicely. Of course, as always, there are fast students, and there are slow students. But there is one thing that bothers me: students doze often during class. Is this because of their rigorous schedule?

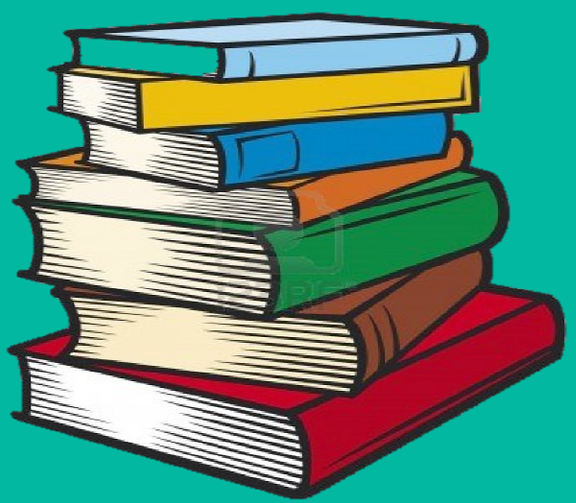
MH: That is probably so. KMLA students have much more to pay attention to compared to ordinary high school students.
Mr. Lee: I thought so. But actually, I think that it's a good sign; students here seem to pay more attention to actually developing themselves. It's much better than always being conscious of college enrollment, in my opinion.

MH: Are there any courses—aside from SAT physics and other similar classes—that you want to teach?
Mr. Lee: Well, I would like to teach the history of physics. I think it is important to know how physicists in the past thought about a subject. These things I sometimes talk about during class. And talking about the changes in physics that occurred during the 20th century is always fun.

MH: Finally, what do you want to accomplish as a teacher in KMLA?
Mr. Lee: My ultimate goal is to become an interesting teacher, I guess.

MH: Thank you for sincerely answering to every question, Mr. Lee. This is the end of our interview, and once again, welcome to KMLA. We hope that your teaching experience in KMLA becomes a good one.

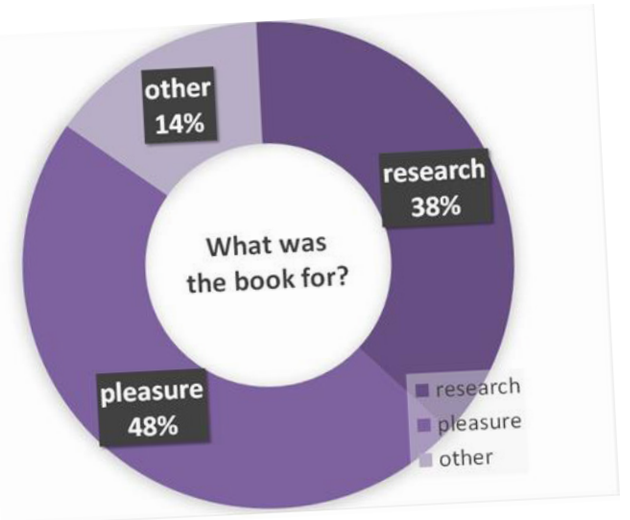
Han Ji-Won
Staff Writer, 18th Wave

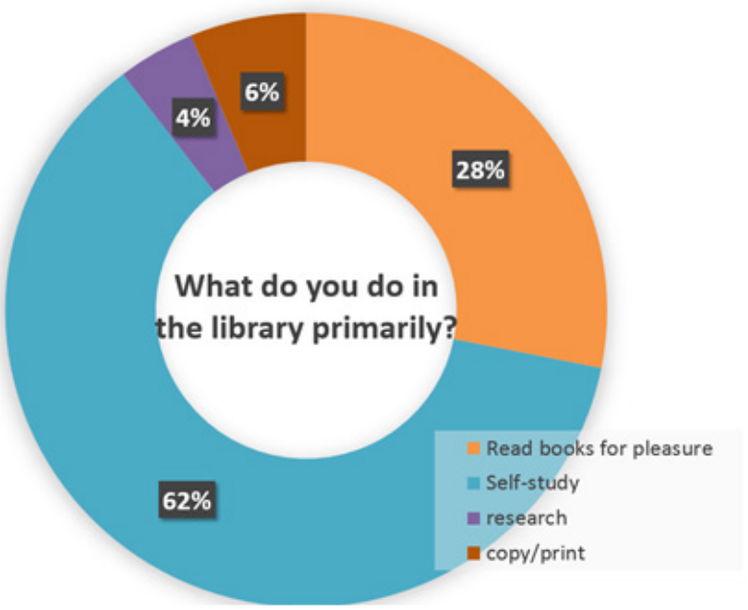


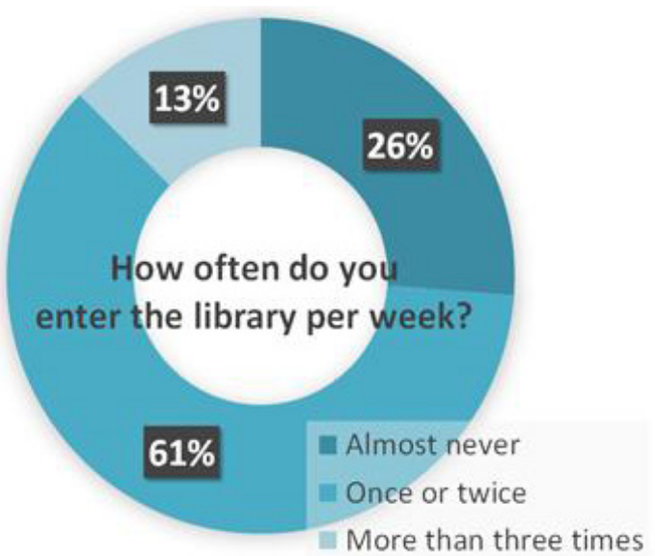
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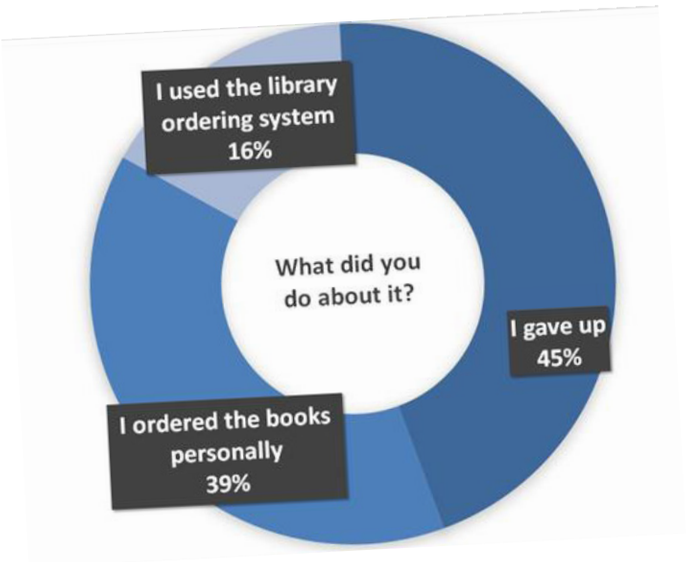


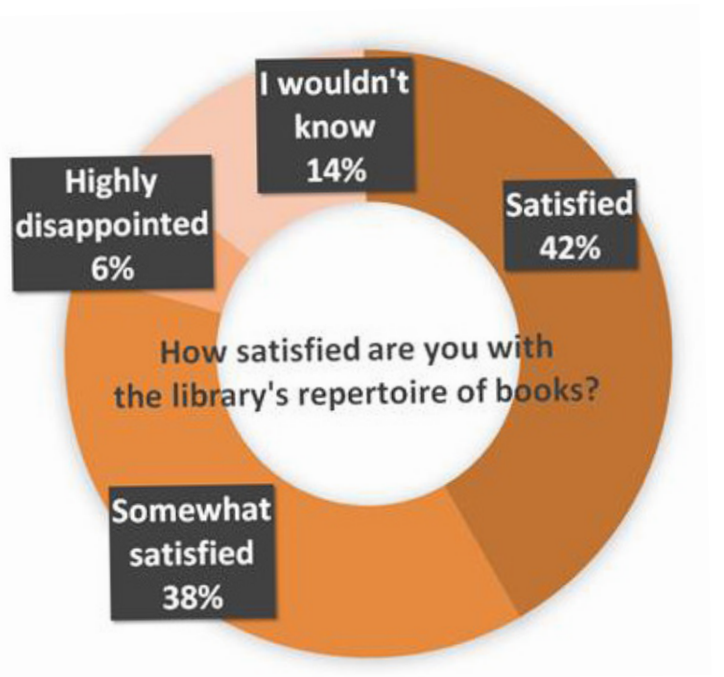


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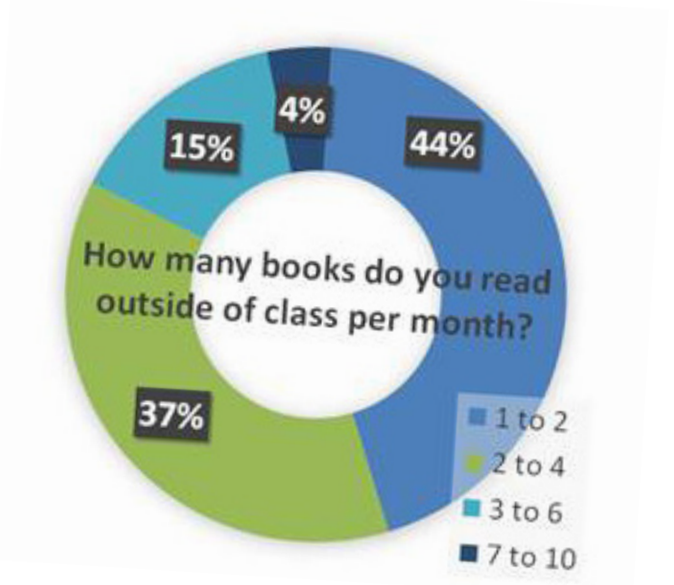
Welcome to Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, the school with a great library with rows of books, Teacher-Accompanied Reading Classes, and comfortable spots students can settle in and read. What more can any book-lover wish for? In fact, a visitor may easily imagine KMLAians sitting on their chairs or lying on their beds with eyes wide open and a book held in their hands. However, the same visitor may be surprised to discover that many KMLA students do not read as much as he or she might imagine. Within our hectic lives, what has our book life boiled down to be?

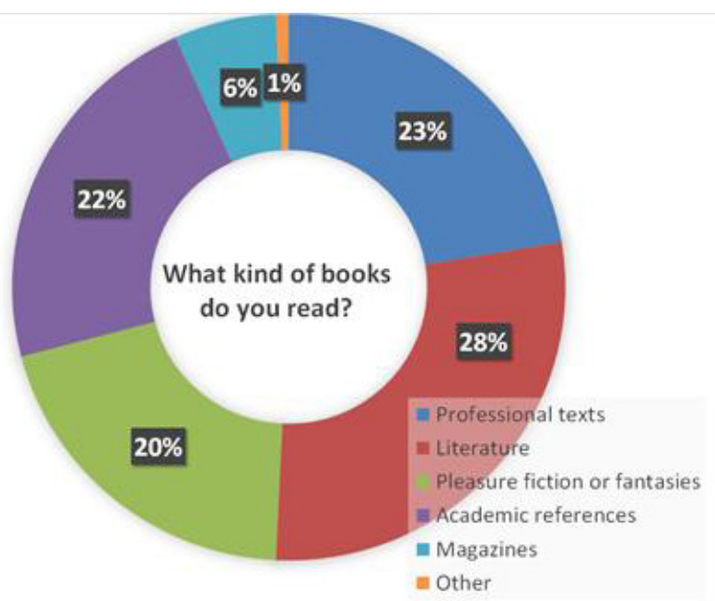
To find out, Minjok Herald launched a detailed survey. What members found were somewhat disturbing. In response to the question, "How many books do you read outside of class—including Teacher Accompanied Reading—per month?" over 44% students replied "1 to 2 books." Considering that Teacher Accompanied Reading Class books were included, it appears as if a large number of students do not read any books besides the ones they are required to





READ?





in these courses.

We have infrastructure, we have the academic fervor: Why is it that the students do not read? When asked to explain, numerous students replied that they lack the time to read. One student even stated, "If our school sincerely wants students to read, give us some time." Students elucidated that with their hectic academic life, they do not have much time left for reading. Moreover, many students answered that the school does not seem to try hard to make students read. "I have not seen any encouragement yet and I am not sure I will," stated one respondent. The actual percentage of students who believed the school does not consistently promote reading outside the classroom was 48.9%, nearly half of all students who participated in the survey. Now that we have taken a glance at the statistics, it indeed appears that we need changes. The question is: how? In this section, we discuss the what and the how in promoting reading. We hope you gain a broad insight on the topic at hand through our articles. Now, sit back, relax, and join us in our investigation.



KMLAians: Bookworms Unlike Korean Students?

According to a Survey of Public Reading conducted by the Ministry of Culture, Sports and Tourism in 2013, Korean high school students read about 32 books a year on average, a notable increase when compared to about 24 books a year in the 2011 survey. 96% of students now read books regularly, which is higher than the adults' percentage of 72%. The same survey shows that 31% of citizens older than 15 regularly use public library, a percentage equivalent to that of the European Union. Although South Korean students have been formerly criticized for neglecting reading, the situation has greatly improved throughout the passage of time. How do KMLAians compare?

An online survey was conducted, asking how much books in average they read annually. Thirty-six 18th wavers responded. According to the results of the survey, 40% of students read 10 to 15 books a year. 20% read more than 30 books, but another 20% read only between 5 and 10 books. 10% have responded that they read less than 5 books a year. Kim Ho-Sung, an 18th waver who is considering a major in literature, confessed that although he tries to read whenever he has time, he is only able to read about 15 books a year. That is not a small number when compared to the majority of KMLA students. However, the saddening truth is that in general KMLA students read even less than their peers.

The primary reason for this general dearth of reading is that the hectic schedule of KMLA makes it hard for students to find spare time to read books that are unrelated to exams and quizzes ahead. Many students complain that they do not even have the time to read their books for Teacher Accompanied Reading Class. Students have to write English essays, study for math quizzes, prepare PowerPoint presentations, write thesis paper for research project classes, and they have but four hours a day to finish this amount of workload. For most students, reading is considered a luxury.

Reading should be encouraged more. Other schools seem to be implementing more aggressive policies in light of the importance of reading. For example, in case of the Hankuk Academy of Foreign Studies, there is a reading program called RND which is a mandatory curriculum for every international humanity branch student and they read and discuss about books for at least 4 hours a week with teachers. They write analytic book reports and are rigorously edited until they show quality understanding of the book content, which is similar to our own program of Teacher Accompanied Reading. In that light, better enforcement of Teacher Accompanied Reading is worth considering—though there are incentive policies to encourage reading such as Mankyung Book Report Competition and Minjok Virtue of Reading, these are not mandatory for KMLAians.

Of course, getting good scores on quizzes and tests is imperative. Reading, however is a fundamental part of education, absolute in its importance. Although starting to read regularly may be hard at first, the best way to begin is to pick up a book nearby and start going through a few pages. By making reading a habit, students will discover that it is much easier to find time for reading. 18th waver Park Hyung-Ryun, who has been awarded for reading the most number of books from the school library, says that it is most important for students to feel familiar with reading rather than perceiving it as an academic burden.

It would be a good idea for the school to encourage using the school library by implementing other policies with intentions similar to Teacher Accompanied Reading Classes. But this is not simply the responsibility of the school officials. KMLAians should recognize that when they themselves make strong efforts to read at least as much as their peers outside the school do, and in the long run as much as their foreign peers do, they will reap much more benefits than they can initially imagine.

Kim Woon-Ha
Staff Feature Writer, 18th Wave



Mr. Kim Dong-Myeong, our school's Teacher Librarian

Library Resources Shown to be In Want of Student Attention

In throwing light upon the realities, both depressing and encouraging, of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy's reading trends, Minjok Herald found Teacher-Librarian Mr. Kim Dong-Myeong's observations and comments essential. Our conversation with Mr. Kim revealed active use of library as imperative. After all, the library is open to requests for purchase both online and offline.

"How and mostly why do the students use the library?" "Students usually buy books that they personally need on their own – they do not really rely on the library to access the books they want to read. It is to read books that are hard to order or too expensive that students come to the library for help", answered Mr. Kim, at the start of the interview. Mr. Kim expressed his concern over the present status where students were not effectively utilizing the fully budgeted library to buy or access books. He explained that "Instead of individually purchasing the books of personal needs, if students requested the books on library purchase, this would enable their friends and the future KMLAians to have access to the new, useful, and recommendable books".

Mr. Kim particularly encouraged the ordering of foreign books, mentioning the Library Initiative (See 2013 December issue for details) as the lead runner. Currently, the Mankyung Library holds 25,000 Korean books, while it only holds 9,800 books of international production—a 72 to 28 ratio. "The motive is to encourage students to order more books from the library. Currently, most of the foreign books are being ordered by teachers. However, this program lets the students to order foreign books that they are interested by themselves. Thus, beyond the simple meaning of supplement, this library-initiative project has the ultimate goal of making students actively participate in book order," explained Mr. Kim.

To those who fear for the limitation of the library's budget, Mr. Kim did not forget to mention that the budget is not a problem at all, for the Mangyung Library is being funded sufficiently, and only a handful of teachers are filling out the purchase-request forms. He pointed out the fact that the library budget allocated for student purchase has been decreasing for the past few years. In 2011, a total of 12,500,000 won was allowed for student book-purchase, but as students only spent 50%, the budget was cut to 9,900,000 won starting from 2012 until now. However, as unenthusiastic the student purchase could get, students only spent 35% of the allotted budget (3,500,000 won). In addition to the problem of the decreasing library budget for students, Mr. Kim also mentioned the drop in the number of books being borrowed. In 2012, the 17th wavers borrowed 1,100 books in their first grade. In 2013, the 18th wavers had only borrowed 795 books.

Students can always request for the purchase of books they need with only a few steps. Log-in to the school library internet homepage, click "My Page" and even the most expensive books will be available to you through the "Purchase Materials" link.

After making his suggestion to actively participate in library-book-purchase, he also mentioned what he believes to be the ideal reading habits and the best way to use the library—reading clubs. "I really think that Reading Clubs can work fantastically—a group of students reading a book together, and then sharing their opinions on the book. This process is great because everyone can learn a lot as each person will surely have different thoughts and opinions even when reading the same book."

As the interview reached its end, Mr. Kim also talked about a very promising, but not well-known usage of the library. "The library does provide a lot of DB (data base) online—one example is the Britannica Encyclopedia, another is DBPI, a national data base of research papers – which students are free to use for their research! Not many students know about this, but I sure do hope more students would use them."

At the end of the day, Minjok Herald finds potential for growth in our library. Supported by active student purchase, formation of grassroots reading clubs, and use of online database, we hope to see our library become the heart of our academic campus, as it was always meant to be.

Cho Woo-Hyun
Staff Feature Writer, 18th Wave



An example of a well-run Teacher Accompanied Reading Class, Mr. Garrioch's class is valued for the depth it provides on reading.

Teacher Accompanied Reading Class: The Gap between Ideals and Reality

"A class in which a student can ponder upon hidden messages and implications from the content of a book through active discussion with a teacher and other students, including upperclassmen."

"An opportunity that provides students with time to read books they choose."

These are general explanations of Teacher Accompanied Reading Class written on our school home page. Teacher Accompanied Reading Class is a mandatory reading course which takes place every second period of Monday. Once in every eight weeks, students enroll for different classes run by different teachers on the online site. As the enrollment is conducted according to the 'first-come-first-served' principle, some 'popular classes' are full within ten seconds.

Then why do students choose certain classes over others for their Teacher Accompanied Reading Classes? A survey conducted among 18th wavers revealed that twelve out of twenty-seven students would deliberately choose lenient classes which consist not of discussions or in-depth reading under teacher's instruction but of self-studying, preparing for the next class, or sleeping. While ten others said they wanted "to get an opportunity to have classes with their favorite teacher", only five students responded that they chose certain classes "to read books they wanted to read". If we only look at the outcome of the survey, the result tells us the second period of Monday is self-study period or simply, free time under the fancy name of Teacher Accompanied Reading Class.

An 18th waver who wished to remain anonymous admitted that he chose classes in which they were able to do work unrelated to the class. Plus, he added, certain classes were noted among students for having teachers who did not strictly check whether students read books or not. A 17th waver Jang Seok-Woo expressed his worries about the current situation in which Teacher Accompanied Reading Class is not taken seriously not only by some teachers but also by students who want easy-going classes. Adding onto that, 18th waver Park Seong-Min admitted there were Teacher Accompanied Reading Class in which neither 'teacher accompanied' part nor 'reading' was being promoted. "Ironically, there are Teacher Accompanied Reading Class where teachers do not held any discussions or students do not read the books," she said.

However, Teacher Accompanied Reading Class does have potential of "enhancing their literary skills by the various tasks implemented by the teacher," as 18th waver Kim Kang-San put it. He suggested that "various means such as asking questions and in-class discussions" may help students in fostering in-depth thinking. Students' active participation will play a determining role in order for the classes to pursue those original purposes. One opinion suggested books choices available should reflect students' own demand. Currently, options for Teacher Accompanied Reading Class are chosen by the teachers and are not replaced by new choice of books for most of cases. Another opinion pointed at the fact that the role of teachers was crucial in making active reading atmosphere. It suggested that it was teachers who were to trigger active discussions or participations from students as the name "Teacher Accompanied" part suggested.

The value of Teacher Accompanied Reading Class comes from in-depth discussion in which students share their thoughts with teachers. In the current situation where the fundamental purpose of Teacher Accompanied Reading Class is unclear, one should question whether or not the classes are practical in promoting such value. If students feel the need they ought to play an active role in demanding changes to revive the meaning of Teacher Accompanied Reading Class. Whether those classes have clear directionality or not will depend on how this problem is addressed in the future.

Je Gyung-Hyun
Staff Feature Writer, 18th Wave

The Importance of Attitude: Mr. Ganse's Advice on the Library

Since Korean Minjok Leadership Academy was established, the school library has always been one of the biggest merits of the school, equipped with thousands of books for students' research and self-studying. Having once won the best library award from the government, the library has always been, and still is, a place where students can study and research independently. However, recently, there have been voices expressing worries about how the school library is currently being used. In order to investigate such concerns, *Minjok Herald* visited Mr. Alexander Ganse, one of the teachers who most frequently visit the library and have clear views about the current state of the school library.

When questioned about how he views the school library itself, Mr. Ganse's first reaction was quite positive. "Compared to other high school libraries, it is the best… or at least one of the best," he said. The biggest problem, according to Mr. Ganse, actually lies in the fact that many students do not use this vast amount of books when they research for additional information. He expressed concerns over the phenomenon of students using the library only "as a place to write papers or to sleep," while using the Internet as the only source of information. Even worse, the phenomenon has been getting "worse in the couple of years." Many students do not even try to look for reference books in the library although the library holds more than enough amounts of books that can be helpful for students' research.

Mr. Ganse's concerns were not only limited to how often students access the library for research. He was also dissatisfied with how even the library personnel do not try hard to keep the rules of the library. For instance, there are many cases in which students borrow books with the R mark and take them out of the library when these books are allowed only inside the library. Mr. Ganse also pointed out that the library personnel occasionally eat food within the library when it is forbidden to do so. Furthermore, he was also greatly upset about how students treat library books. "..I absolutely hate it when somebody folds over the book. It's damaging the book. Also I hate it when somebody is writing in the book which is not his," He expressed further disappointment toward students who tear books apart. "This is vandalism. We should support a culture of respecting the books."

When asked about what possible measures the library or the school can take to increase students' visits to the school library for academic purposes, Mr. Ganse stated that we shouldn't demand the library for unconditional help. Rather, he insisted that the teachers should promote students' usage of the library. He mentioned that he always introduces his classes to the library at the start of the courses. He even deducts points when students write papers without using book references even when the library has pertinent and helpful books. He also stated that in order to promote students' usage of the library, the library "needs to have sufficient quality books so that it appeals to the teachers and the students who have papers to write for the classes" instead of having "a bunch of books which do not belong there, like SAT prep books." Like Mr. Ganse's classes, teachers can provide similar incentives for students to do their research inside the library in order to familiarize students with the school library. He further pointed out that the library should have only quality academic books to help students study, providing proper reference basis for students' papers and presentations and thus motivating them to make use of the school library often.

Clearly, a plethora of books is not enough for a great library. Only when students use the library frequently and properly, and only when teachers actively promote students to use the library in such ways will the school library work up to its full potential.

Na Woo-Joo
Staff Feature Writer, 18th Wave





The Department of Library Management Shown to be in Dire Need of Revival

The library in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy is rarely used for pleasure reading or the exploration of such books. There are students in the library, but not many of them are reading. The Department of Library Management has attempted to make library activities prosper. However, the library has yet to come alive.

One of the activities the Department of Library Management has initiated is the library newspaper. In order to encourage more students to utilize the library with better efficiency, the department members is releasing articles introducing the hidden aspects of the library. The first edition has been already released, during the fall semester of 2013; the problem is that no one really knew. This is not the end of the problem, however. In the process of finding out more about the library newspaper, it seemed that even the individual members of the Department of Library Management did not know exactly what they were doing. 18th waver Lyu Seung-Woo, the present Head of the Department of Library Management was not an exception. When asked about the project, the response was, "Ask Ko Hae-Wook, the 17th waver and previous Head, for more details as he was the one who charted the project." We met with similar responses during conversations with other 17th and 18th waver members of the Department of Library Management.

It may be thought that there has not been practical change because of the student body's lack of interest. However, when not even department members know the activities taking place within, the gravity of the situation could not be more stark. Efforts to continue past initiatives to improve reading habits on part of students seem to be missing from the Department of Library Management. Their exertion on this score would certainly encourage students to take more interest in the library's affairs; without it, such aspects seem to be dim at best.

Certainly, the Department has to work on guaranteeing sustainability of its projects. Succeeding Heads should feel responsibility for maintenance of past achievements. If the Department of Library Management wishes to make an impact, its leadership transit must be more thorough, its motivation of the members stronger, and its agenda more straightforward.

The past efforts made by the Department of Library Management are quite worthy of praise. However, the department should know that for actual change, a fundamental change within their department is also a necessity.

Ha Su-Min
Staff Feature Writer, 18th Wave



Kim Ye-Seul, Editor-in-Chief

For Whom the Bell Tolls (Ernest Hemingway)

The bloodiness of the Spanish Civil War comes alive with Hemingway's intensely terse prose with this novel. I personally suggest reading John Donne's "No Man is an Island" with it.



2014 EDITORS' CHOICE



Lee Sun-Ha, Managing Editor

The Guernsey Literary and Potato Peel Pie Society (Mary Ann Shaffer and Annie Barrows)

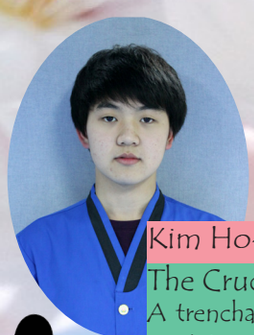
A book full of warmth—through letters flying back and forth between strangers and friends, the author paints a society of people so temptingly imperfect it almost pains you to realize that they are not right beside you.



Cho Nam-Eek, Copy Editor

To Kill a Mockingbird (Harper Lee)

Written from a child's perspective, meant to be naïve, this book ironically delivers a point that belies such innocence—a message that transcends generations and worlds. A recognized classic, the book is certainly worth a read.



Kim Ho-Sung, Chief Editor, News Department

The Crucible (Arther Miller)

A trenchant portrayal of the Salem Witch Trials, the book contains certain similarities between the perversions of justice then and today. "Dear God, what meaning does it give if your name is used not for penitence but pretense?"



Roh Hye-Sung, Deputy Editor, News Department

The Alchemist (Paulo Coelho)

So much insight crystallized into a very simple plot, this is not a book to be read just once—repeated reading helps one discover the many layers in the story, in the way that inlaying different shades of watercolor will add depth to a painting.



Kim Woon-Ha,
Chief Editor, Features Department

Collapse: How Societies Choose to Fail or Succeed (Jared Diamond)

A reading of Jared Diamond's Pulitzer Prize-Winning work, "Gun, Germs and Steel" led me to search out the lesser-known of his books. A sweeping history of civilization, the book is both educational and entertaining.



Hong Ji-Hun,
Chief Editor, Op-Ed Department

The Invisible Man (Ralph Ellison)

"The Invisible Man is a American classic novel that portrays the status of black identity in early 20th century America. The same messages apply to the status quo—after all, racism is still an issue very much alive in contemporary society.

A Conversation on Student Autonomy: Where to Go Next?



The 16th Legislative Council



The 16th Judicial Council



A miscellaneous
of the members o
Student Cou

The last Student Council election was met by unprecedented interest and concerns regarding the state of the Student Council and student autonomy in general. *Minjok Herald* encourages this trend, and also urges students to continue their keen interest on such matters, issues that can and will directly affect the lives of students at Korean Minjok Leadership Academy.

Here, two senior editorialists, all former Student Council members, discuss the prospects for and offer a novel perspective on the future of the Student Council. We start by exploring the significance of student autonomy, both in substance and in theory.

Kim Ha-Young: The concept of "student autonomy" that the last Student Council has pushed for, I worry, focuses too heavily on ideology. The 17th Student Council seems to be taking a similar approach.

Sung Ho-Kyung: What do you mean?

Kim: I mean, the Student Council no longer seems to care about the hands-on issues, you know, the problems and changes that affect the students' everyday lives. I think it's aiming too high: it wants a true "student autonomy" where students get to make actual decisions, but is that really what the Student Council should be about?

Sung: I do think that is a valid point. There was this one question that constantly bothered me throughout the term—is the Student Council really supposed to have the power it wants? Although I myself pushed this ideological movement for power, and although I still do believe that a part of the Student Council's job is to actualize "student autonomy," I felt that I was negligent when it came to the real issues that I could actually solve as a Student Council member.

Kim: Exactly. Do you remember upperclassmen Chonghyun Ahn's speech during the morning assembly last year? The one about speaking up to the injustices that we face here in KMLA? I think it received quite an applause from the students. And as far as I remember, it was not supposed to just end there. Ahn and the Student Council had planned it for quite a while.

Sung: Yes, and?

Kim: I thought it would arouse something. Something different from the past. But nothing happened. Nobody knew what should be changing either. Then I realized that this simply repeats itself in every term of each student council—an endless cycle of floating ideas. Yes, ideologies are important, and the endless talks about "communication" may someday bring some great changes. But I daresay 'we' are not prepared. The student mass have no concrete urge yet to solidify the ideological push of the student council. In this state, nothing can change by just a group of vanguards—in this case, the Student Council—tugging the immovable mass. Before students themselves change, all these efforts would be useless.



The 16th Executive Council



Three senior columnists and former members of student government get together for a chat on student democracy



collection
f the 16th
ncil

Sung: I get your point, but I would not call the effort just useless. There were definitely some tangible changes. For instance, during the last election, not only were there ample comments on the candidates' assignments posted on KMLA Online, but also some critical questions were raised during the question-and-answer sessions. It was different from the past years of dull and empty election periods.

Kim: Yes, but I believe the last election's changes should be attributed more to the expanded role of the student media. *Minjok Herald* and Bulhwi held extensive press conferences from the Q&A sessions, featured articles for each Student Council, and produced briefing posters every day. It was almost impossible to ignore all those 'fuss' for any of us. What I saw from those briefings, was that it is not the students who truly cared about the candidates' stances, but rather the media wreaking havoc.

Sung: But for some issues, a majority of students actually felt strongly about, and those voices were shared in the class conferences. The problem is that no matter how high the approval rate was, even at times over 90%, the Student Council could not, and did not have enough power to carry through the students' opinions against the school. Big issues that will, either in the short term or long term, affect the students exist and for these, the Student Council must continuously push towards an ideological basis in which the student body can be truly heard.

Kim: Even so, do you think we can truly overcome the student-school paradigm? No matter what, the school will not change their perspective on the Student Council. For them, as mentioned in the KMLA official website, the Student Council exists not for the betterment of the student mass, but for an experience of a model-three-branched government—a mini replica of the society.

Sung: Yes, but at the same time, as long as the Headmaster's greetings in the school website proudly dictates that the school runs a tripartite student republic, as long as the school truly believes it to be educating global leaders of the world, and as long as we do not want the Student Council to be just another extracurricular activity for college admissions, the Student Council should, at least, try to do something real.

Kim: Hmm... I see. But I just think that the "hands-on" issues should be equally prioritized. Things like laundry or leftover food problems. Those are issues that the Student Council can actually bring changes with some effort. Student Council should be a group of leaders "and" servants, not hypothetical dreamers.

Sung: Exactly! That's what I was thinking. It looks as if we had the same thought from the beginning. Just different approaches.

Kim: I guess so. Ideological and practical, we should not forget that both reformations are necessary. Hope the 17th and the future Student Councils keep this in mind.

Sung Ho-Kyung and Kim Ha-Young, as recorded by Cho Seung-Hyun
Staff Editorialists, 17th Wave

That's Right: Free to Study



A student sleeps on a sofa in the Dasan Hall, apparently during study hall.

In Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, students are faced with tricky dilemmas; we are supposed to develop independence, yet sometimes we feel we are not given the corresponding amount of freedom. The most characteristic of this seemingly contradictory requirement is the self-study periods. The only thing allowed to do during this four-hour long period seems to be studying, with club activities de jure forbidden (although de facto carried out). We are even supervised and scrutinized by our dorm parents, who patrol the rooms to check if students are precipitating and not dozing off. I have met many people who are discontent with such oppressive measures taken by the school, asking for deregulations and more autonomy. Perhaps I am going against a majority here, but I believe that it is only right that these four hours are regulated.

The confusion seems to be a semantic one—that these heavily regulated afternoon periods are called "self-study periods." The students who ask for more freedom have a different opinion. I assume that they would prize the degree of autonomy guaranteed to the students, as supported by the fact that we can choose our own subjects and roam around the vast school property. This is of course an iconic and much celebrated aspect of the school. However, I believe in the case of self-study periods, autonomy is not the essential element, and cannot apply in the same way.

The word "self" must be more closely understood, as it not only contains the meaning of autonomy but also implies the meaning of solitude. My idea of "self-study periods" is something of solitary preparation. We should be spending time of our own, for all of the obvious benefits like harnessing academic capabilities, developing endurance, etc. Of course, when help is needed help should be sought. The peer tutoring system would come in handy for this purpose. However, club activities are of a completely different nature. When we engage ourselves in club activities we are working as a team, and although experiences like discussion, debate, or presentations can be of great value, it is hard to say that they provide the same sort of advantages as reading a book. Studying on our own just cannot be replaced by club activities, and vice versa. In this regard, it is important to ensure that we have time enough for both. Therefore the school is only reasonable to assign so much time for self-study, a staggering 28 hours a week, because it is that much important. This is quite a proportionate measure, actually, because for club activities the school has assigned as many as three weekends a month, during which we are not allowed to return home and are instead supposed to participate in club activities.

The second contention from the libertarians is that student-led schedules are so much more practical. After all, isn't it best for the individual to decide for themselves, as lessons from the market economy tell us? For this, I believe the principle of judgment applied is not much different from daytime classes. There are certain subject requirements that we must take, and the schedules, although flexible, are not as free as universities. This is the level of trust, the invisible line of freedom that society has tacitly drawn for high school. Likewise, some rigidness during the self-study periods is warranted.

It is certainly tempting to believe that we should be able to do whatever we want to during the self-study periods. The term "self-study" is not as lenient as we think, however, because it is not an unconditional provision of freedom, but something with actual implications to the students' future. We should be more understanding of the school's policies regarding self-study periods, as they make more sense than we commonly think of.

Kim Jang-Won
Staff Columnist, 18th Wave

Not Right: Distinguishing Enemies



English Debate Society conducts a debate session for potential members during a self-study period. For EDS, self-study period activities are essential to practices.

Korean Minjok Leadership Academy is not just a lecturing hall, not just a gate to college; it is a place where intellectual curiosity, human connection, and moral responsibility comes alive. I believe these values are most thoroughly represented in student club activities. Yet, while this flower of KMLA should be radiating these great values to its fullest potential, this flower is instead being asphyxiated. The reenactment of restrictions regarding student club activities, with permission slips being required for club activities in self-study periods, has created a giant barrier in doing club work—inhibiting the entire club culture of KMLA.

The debate begins with a revival of a dormant regulation, once forgotten, that would bring back the need to hand in a permission slip approved and signed by Mr. Kim Myeong-Soon, Director of the Division of Student Affairs, and Mr. Kwak No-Je, Manager of the Office of Extracurricular Activities, before doing any club related activities during self-study periods. The purpose of this regulation, according Mr. Kwak, is "to ensure that students do club works under the condition that the right to study is not violated." He further stated that the only time clubs would be allowed to take part in club activities is when there is an inevitable need, such as preparing for the Minjok Music Festival. Activities like English debate is currently unauthorized, Mr. Kwak refusing to give permission for the use of lecture halls in the dormitory at night.

This policy, supposedly protecting "the right to study", clearly has many problems. To begin with, the decision-making process did not involve student input. The policy silently came into effect, without introduction through student votes or surveys. Student clubs are run almost exclusively by students, teacher involvement notwithstanding; the students are the most relevant in this issue, meaning that there needs to be at least some sort of consent or discussion process. It seems that the school had completely neglected the students' opinion on this issue.

Moreover, the school's attitude toward club activities is also questionable. Student clubs are not just some group of students fooling around, but an embodiment of KMLA's virtue of "going beyond the classroom" and enjoying the fruits of exertion outside academics. For the sake of these values, I feel the school should show willingness to support and promote student club activities. In that sense, a complete ban, as opposed to discouragement, on all club activities is a highly questionable policy.

Then again, one might argue that the school does provide support for clubs by allocating time in the weekend for such activities. Such a stance shows how little the school understands about student clubs at KMLA. Considering that many students go home on weekends, the time practically available for club use is 4 to 6 days per month, meaning that students have to cram in all their club activities into 6, 8 hours of continual work twice a month—clearly much more inefficient than the flexible, spread out schedule that clubs once had. In addition, the generalization that club activities can be completely adjusted to fit a rigid schedule is clearly not acceptable. Activities like debate or orchestra require constant and frequent practices. If clubs were only allowed on weekends, then how are KMLA clubs different from those of average high schools, let alone of middle schools? This supposedly "helpful" effort of the school seems to turn the proud culture of KMLA into mundane, banal gatherings.

What action needs to be done in this conflict? Surely indifference is another form of carelessness, as KMLA is an educational institution with the duty to make students study. The ideal solution needs to embody a balance between liberty and regulation, which requires continual communication between the students and the school. Yet, in the status quo, the new policy just seems to harm what KMLA holds dear—its lively and energetic atmosphere, its culturally enriched life, and its autonomous pursuit of knowledge.

Hwang In-Gyu
Staff Columnist, 18th Wave

A Case for Abolishing Clause 6

Mr. Kim Myung-Soon, the Director of the Division of Student Affairs, has recently proposed a new policy regarding EOP. In one morning assembly few weeks ago, he announced that he will put the clause 6, article 16 of the School Guidance Code, a clause which states that students who violated the EOP may be banned from taking weekend leaves for a certain period of time, into use. The school recently announced its activation due to continual violations of EOP. However, the clause in the School Guidance Code itself, is, from cover to back, very unreasonable.

It is not that EOP is wrong. In fact, most of students agree with its purpose and aim; we must be proficient in English to succeed in a globalized society. The problem, however, lies in how the school enforces EOP, and whether EOP is right or wrong is out of scope in this debate. In this respect, clause 6 is a highly ineffective and unjustifiable way of enforcing EOP.

When evaluating a corrective measure, one should assess the measure in mainly two perspectives. First, is the punishment reasonable? Second, is the punishment effective in deterring students from violating a regulation? Clause 6, on which the recent policy proposed by Mr. Kim bases itself on, fails to qualify for both of these criteria.

Restricting weekend leaves for violating the EOP regulation is an unreasonable form of corrective measure in mainly three levels. First, the punishment goes against the principle of proportionality. The principle of proportionality states that there must be a balance between the restriction imposed by a corrective measure and the severity of the nature of the prohibited act. In this case, how can one be banned from going home in the weekends, even if one has to participate in an important competition, simply because one has used Korean in school? Anyone with a rational mind could easily come to see that there is a clear imbalance in this situation. Putting into use this clause to simply keep students from using Korean is "cutting off one's nose to spite one's face."

The second aspect concerns fairness of the corrective measure compared to corrective measures of other prohibited acts. For example, if one gets a life prison for stealing a loaf of bread while the other gets a fine for murder, the justice system should not be called just and fair. The same story applies to the clause. A student who violates outdoor regulation receives two demerit points. Another student who used Korean only once that day, but unluckily was caught by a member of the EOP department will receive demerit points and potential restriction on weekend leaves. Is this system fair? Certainly, the answer would be no. Restricting weekend policy is an over-punishment compared to punishments of other acts.

On top of this, restriction on weekend leaves is an unusual form of punishment. In KMLA, most prohibited acts are punished by demerit points. The merit and demerit point system has been established in the first place to replace the anachronistic way of punishing students and furthermore punish all misdemeanors through demerit points. The school's decision to penalize EOP violators with restrictions on weekend leaves is very arbitrary, considering the status quo in which all punishments come through demerit points. In order to propose such a strange punishment, the school has a burden to justify the link between EOP violation and weekend leaves. Is there a sufficient link between the two? We have yet to hear a satisfactory answer from the Student Guidance Committee.

In fact, implementation of this clause produces adverse effects. If the new policy based on this law is implemented, members of the EOP department will be reluctant to catch EOP violators. Members of the department are aware that catching EOP might give an enormous disadvantage to the EOP violator. Members will feel sorry for the EOP violator and become reluctant to catch EOP violators. This, in the end, will cause the collapse of the EOP enforcement system.

Some may refute to this claim by saying that the School Guidance Code is still a law established by an implied consensus of the members of the society. However, a law is never absolute. If the law is unjust, it is reasonable that we, as responsible members of a liberal democracy, challenge the law and strive to change the law. A law was made to solve social problems in the first place, not engender them.

It is true that the school is in need of measures that would ensure the enforcement of EOP. But the school should not start implementing any and every policy without thinking closely on the issue. An effective measure can come only after a deep public discourse on reasons that students violate EOP in the status quo. Only then will the school be able to sincerely persuade students to comply with EOP.

Soak Yourself in the Past

The following is Sung Hwi-Yeon's response to Minjok Herald's Literary and Drawing Contest topic, Reflect on Yourself. Her work received top honors in the competition.

Mirrors. A window, in a darkened room. Pools of clear water, with no bottom in sight.
One's reflection can only be seen on smooth surfaces. Any disturbance will result in a disrupted reflection, imperfect through omission or exaggeration, a play of the light. Perhaps there is no such thing as a perfectly smooth surface; perhaps we will never truly grasp what we truly look like to others; perhaps all the pictures and mirror reflections we see are flawed imitations.

When it comes to one's inner self, reflecting on oneself is not such a different matter from looking oneself in the mirror. This is a process that takes place entirely inside our consciousness; as a result, the mind is the mirror and the face in the mirror, too. Unlike our physical representations, it is possible to probe through one's thoughts, to analyze them, shuffle through them, to pause, laugh, frown, and remember. We reminiscence, and we feel: regret, dread, humiliation; pride, amazement, a sense of longing(the desire to "go back"). We feel, and therefore the mirror that we all have is an imperfect one, even more so than the actual mirror on the bathroom wall. The latter is bothered by technicalities, but the former is plagued by emotion. What is past is inevitably tinted with beauty, and sooner or later, we all reminiscence the "good old days", when they never truly were. Those moments of joy and pain have all been drained of color and remain. Such pallid beauty! Enjoy the moment, but soak yourself in the past as well.

So when I reflect on myself, it is actually a reflection on my ever-increasing past. This moment, that I am spending typing these words, flow away from me and slip away from my fingers, and everything passes quickly, silently, naturally. (For are we not all used to time's flow?) And so when I reminiscence, the present and the past become blurred; time is a mysterious thing.
Anyway.

All people are similar. Yet, like all great truths, the opposite of this statement is equally true: all people are different. Such is my past. In retrospect, it was an ordinary life, but the shards of fragmented memories that I contain within the muddy depths of my mind shine, with a unique light that is completely my own. Most of my most precious memories, the diamonds in my jewel stash, are fragments; short memories that last for mere seconds. Some are in vivid Technicolor; some are in shades of dark gray. In some reminisces, I am looking at myself from the outside; I wonder if this is normal.
What do I remember, then?

I remember myself as a child, exact age unknown, sitting in a darkly tinted hotel room. I remember playing with my grandfather there, in my memory his face doesn't appear, it never does, yet I know it is him with absolute certainty. I remember a toy, a large square-shaped toy, and despite the lack of light I know it was a vivid red color. I remember there was a heavy curtain drawn across floor-to-ceiling windows, and somewhere the curtain had parted and a sliver of sunlight had crept in, so I could see the particles of dust floating in the stream of light.

I remember myself at age 8, with my two best friends, promising to remain close forever and ever. I remember the time I spent in the playground with them, how I was scared to hang upside down from the monkey bars, how my friends managed it so easily. I remember staying out late in the playground one day, finally mastering the feat, staring, exhilarated, at the wide soccer field that had suddenly become my sky. I remember how, every time I crossed the school on my way home, I would sneak in and do the exact same thing, and feel the exact same tingle in my heart, the sudden loss of balance, the terrifying fraction of a second when I was freefalling through air – then the exhilaration.

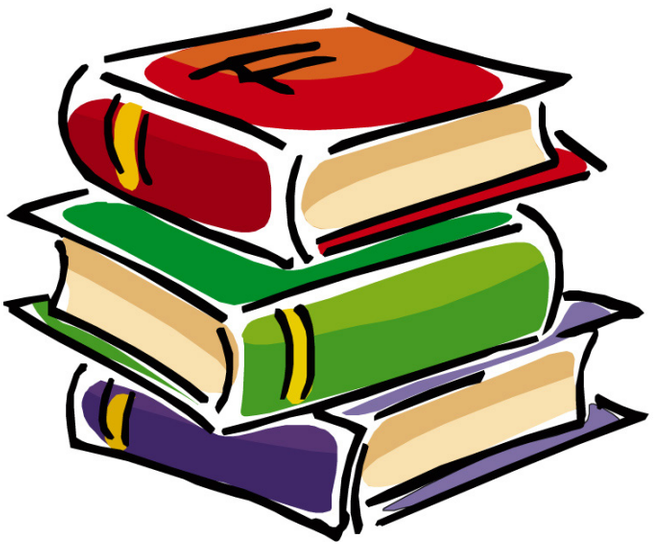
I remember myself at age 13, fighting, arguing, with those exact same friends. I remember how, in the end, we made up; but we were never again the same, and we all knew it.

I remember myself at age 15, when I met the sort of friend that I must have been blessed to meet, the sort that I hope will last a lifetime. I remember the initial desperation that I felt to have a best friend, for I was manically afraid of being alone, and attempting to be close to her, for no particular reason other than how she lacked a best friend as well. I remember that at first, I was apprehensive of her attitude towards others, for she seemed rather outgoing while I tended to shy away from people.

No reminiscence is required anymore. We're still best friends.
These memories are nothing special from the objective eye. It is my intimacy with the events and people within those reminisces that grants it its preciousness. And these innumerable precious moments are what constitute who I am. Some of these shards fit together harmoniously; some are forever in discord, joined at the strangest angle and jutting to the sides. But my past is who I am, and I'm still struggling to accept myself openheartedly. We all have our regrets. And reflecting on myself, there are more than a couple of aspects in my life that I try to hide from. They are the memories that I cannot bear to think about, much less write about.

But as I mentioned earlier, time is magical. It grants most memories beauty and the rest an aura of fate. So reflections should not be painful. They should be quiet, calm, and serendipitous. Unlike the present that continues to jut itself into our lives continually in all its flowering vivaciousness, the past is always distant and polite. Bury me if you wish, it says. But it is also persistent in its reminders, remember me, it whispers. It knocks on the doors of consciousness, every day, every week, every month. So there is no use in attempting to bury a memory. Embrace it; in due time, the tears all fade away. This is the intrinsic flaw in our mind's mirror, the crack that lets the color fade away, and it is a combination of forgetfulness and reminiscence that finishes the job beautifully. The past may have never been the "good old days", but there is nothing wrong with remembering it as such.

Sung Hwi-Yeon
19th Wave



Live always in the best company
when you read.

-Sydney Smith